



DATA FOR GOOD

PROJECT SALT BOX

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September 15, 2026

VIA Electronic Submission

FOIA Officer U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement 500 12th Street SW, Stop 5009
Washington, DC 20536-5009 foia@ice.dhs.gov

CC: Privacy Office, Disclosure and FOIA Program U.S. Department of Homeland Security 245
Murray Lane SW, STOP 0655 Washington, DC 20528-0655 foia@hq.dhs.gov

Re: Freedom of Information Act Request / Expedited Processing Requested

To whom it may concern:

This letter constitutes a request pursuant to the Freedom of Information Act, 5 U.S.C. § 552, seeking records concerning the use of a federally owned warehouse at 1879 Route 46, Roxbury Township, New Jersey (the “Roxbury Warehouse”) in connection with an immigration enforcement action on September 4, 2026. The request is submitted by Project Salt Box, an all-volunteer investigative news organization (“Requester”). It is directed to U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE), Enforcement and Removal Operations, and to any contractor or subcontractor providing security services at the property, and, separately, to the U.S. Department of Homeland Security (DHS) to the extent DHS holds records not held by ICE.

I. Background

The Roxbury Warehouse is the subject of ongoing federal litigation. *See State of New Jersey v. U.S. Immigration & Customs Enforcement*, No. 2:26-cv-02884 (D.N.J. filed Mar. 20, 2026). On May 12, 2026, the court entered a joint stipulation limiting the activities Defendants may undertake at the property pending completion of an environmental assessment. *Id.*, ECF No. 36. Paragraph 4 of that stipulation authorizes Defendants to install “a building security alarm system, which includes temporary CCTV coverage with security trailers that have cameras and lighting.” *Id.*

Community organizations, including Project NINJA (No Ice in North Jersey Alliance), have alleged in a letter to the New Jersey Attorney General’s Office that on September 4, 2026, ICE used the Roxbury Warehouse to hold and transfer individuals arrested during an enforcement action in Dover, New Jersey, approximately seven miles away. The letter alleges that vehicles were observed entering the property between approximately 8:15 a.m. and 8:25 a.m. and departing between approximately 9:23 a.m. and 9:34 a.m. on that date, and that one of the

individuals detained called a family member at 8:52 a.m. from within the property, describing being held in what he characterized as a jail or prison. The letter further alleges that a security guard confronted observers near the property at approximately 11:32 a.m. and that a vehicle associated with the property's security personnel filmed observers at approximately 12:28 p.m.

The parties' representations to the court concerning the future of the property have shifted repeatedly since the stipulation was entered. On June 29, 2026, the parties represented to the court that Homeland Security no longer intended to convert the building and planned to sell it, a representation the court entered as an order. ECF No. 43. On July 10, 2026, Defendants notified the court that, upon reconsideration, DHS officials had determined on July 8, 2026, to proceed with plans to consider retrofitting the warehouse for use as a detention facility. ECF No. 44. Neither filing has been explained publicly by the Department beyond the language of the filings themselves.

Requester is concerned about whether federal enforcement activity at the property on September 4, 2026, complied with the terms of the May 12 stipulation, and, separately, about whether cameras authorized under paragraph 4 of that stipulation were operational on that date and would document the events described above.

The public presently has no information confirming or refuting the account described above. It does not know whether ICE personnel or vehicles were present at the property on September 4, 2026, whether any person was held there, whether the CCTV system authorized under the stipulation was installed and operating on that date, or who was responsible for security services at the property. Video footage, access logs, and contracting records are the records most likely to answer these questions directly. Requester therefore requests the following records.

II. Definitions

For purposes of this request, please apply the following definitions:

"The Property" means the warehouse and surrounding parcel located at 1879 Route 46, Roxbury Township, New Jersey, also identified in filings as Block 9501, Lot 1.

"The Relevant Period" means September 4, 2026, from 7:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m. Eastern time.

"Security Trailer System" means the closed-circuit television, lighting, and alarm equipment described in paragraph 4 of the Order and Joint Stipulation entered May 12, 2026, in *State of New Jersey and Township of Roxbury v. ICE*, No. 2:26-cv-02884 (D.N.J.), ECF No. 36.

"Record" has the meaning given in 5 U.S.C. § 552(f)(2) and includes records in electronic form regardless of the application, platform, or physical medium in which they were created or are stored.

III. Records Sought

Please provide the following records:

1. All closed-circuit television or video footage captured by the Security Trailer System, or by any other camera installed at or covering the Property, during the Relevant Period.
2. Any access log, sign-in sheet, visitor log, or vehicle log documenting entry to or exit from the Property during the Relevant Period.
3. The custodial log required by Section 2.5(B)(2) of the National Detention Standards, documenting the placement in and removal from a hold room of any detainee at the Property on September 4, 2026, and the detention log required by Section 2.5(B)(5) of the same standard, documenting the 15-minute observation checks and the identity of the officer or officers conducting them, for any hold room at the Property on that date.
4. Any use-of-force incident report documented and submitted for review under Standard 2.8 of the National Detention Standards, arising from an interaction between security personnel and a member of the public at the Property on September 4, 2026.

This request covers records regardless of whether they are held by ICE directly, by a contractor or subcontractor, or by another component of DHS, if ICE has the right to obtain them.

Please provide responsive video and log records in native digital format via secure electronic transfer, rather than as printed stills or summaries.

IV. Preservation of Records

Requester asks that ICE and DHS preserve all potentially responsive records pending completion of this request and any administrative appeal or litigation, including video files maintained in systems subject to automatic deletion or overwrite, and including any records maintained by a third-party security contractor on the Department's behalf. Requester notes that CCTV systems of the kind described above commonly overwrite footage on a rolling basis measured in days or weeks, and that any delay in preservation risks the permanent loss of responsive records.

V. Application for Waiver or Limitation of Fees

Requester seeks a waiver of search, review, and duplication fees on the ground that disclosure of the requested records is in the public interest because it is likely to contribute significantly to public understanding of the operations or activities of the government and is not primarily in the commercial interest of the Requester. 6 C.F.R. § 5.11(k); see also 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(4)(A)(iii). Requester separately seeks a limitation of fees as a representative of the news media. 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(4)(A)(ii)(II); 6 C.F.R. § 5.11(b)(6).

A. The request is likely to contribute significantly to public understanding of the operations or activities of the government and is not primarily in the commercial interest of the Requester.

The records sought concern whether a federal agency complied with a standing court order governing its own conduct at a specific property, and whether that agency's own security systems, installed under the authority of that order, documented enforcement activity that community groups allege violated it. Compliance with federal court orders is a core government operation, and the public currently has no information establishing whether the events alleged on September 4, 2026, occurred as described, occurred at all, or were properly documented.

The public interest is heightened by the posture of the underlying litigation. The New Jersey Attorney General's Office is presently considering a request to seek a contempt finding against Defendants arising from the same events, and the parties are due to file a further status report in the litigation on or before September 18, 2026. Records confirming or refuting the allegations bear directly on a live question before a federal court.

Requester is not filing this request to further any commercial interest. Project Salt Box is an all-volunteer organization. Any records disclosed will be published in full and made available to the public at no cost.

B. Requester is a representative of the news media and the records are not sought for commercial use.

Requester meets the statutory definition of a representative of the news media because it is an entity that gathers information of potential interest to a segment of the public, uses its editorial skills to turn the raw material into a distinct work, and distributes that work to an audience. 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(4)(A)(ii)(III); 6 C.F.R. § 5.11(b)(6).

Project Salt Box publishes original investigative reporting on federal contracting, immigration enforcement infrastructure, and federal real property acquisition at projectsaltbox.com, and maintains a public research tool at tracker.projectsaltbox.com. Recent published work includes reporting on detention facility procurement, federal warehouse acquisitions, and the Roxbury Warehouse litigation itself. Requester's reporting has been relied upon by other news organizations. Requester routinely publishes the underlying records it obtains, at no charge, alongside its reporting.

Courts have found comparable organizations to qualify as representatives of the news media. See *Nat'l Sec. Archive v. Dep't of Defense*, 880 F.2d 1381, 1387 (D.C. Cir. 1989) (organization that gathers information, exercises editorial discretion in selecting and organizing documents, and distributes the resulting work to the public is a representative of the news media); *Cause of Action v. IRS*, 125 F. Supp. 3d 145 (D.D.C. 2015); *Judicial Watch, Inc. v. Dep't of Justice*, 133 F. Supp. 2d 52, 53-54 (D.D.C. 2000).

VI. Application for Expedited Processing

Requester seeks expedited processing pursuant to 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(6)(E) and 6 C.F.R. § 5.5(e). There is a compelling need for these records because the information is urgently needed by a person primarily engaged in disseminating information in order to inform the public concerning actual or alleged federal government activity. 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(6)(E)(v)(II).

A. Requester is primarily engaged in disseminating information in order to inform the public about actual or alleged government activity.

Obtaining records about federal government activity, analyzing them, and publishing them to the public are Project Salt Box's primary activities. Requester operates no other line of business. As described in Section V.B, Requester regularly disseminates information to the public through its

website, its public research tool, and releases to other news organizations, and plans to analyze, publish, and disseminate the information obtained through this request at no cost to the public.

B. The records sought are urgently needed to inform the public about actual or alleged government activity.

These records are urgently needed to inform the public about actual or alleged federal government activity. See 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(6)(E)(v)(II); 6 C.F.R. § 5.5(e)(1)(ii). The New Jersey Attorney General's Office is actively considering whether to raise the allegations described in Section I with the presiding judge, and the parties are due to file a status report in the underlying litigation on or before September 18, 2026. Information disclosed after that filing, or after any CCTV footage has been overwritten under the property's routine retention practices, cannot serve the oversight function the FOIA was enacted to support. The urgency is further heightened because the video and access records sought are of a kind commonly subject to short, automatic retention periods, and delay increases the likelihood that responsive records will no longer exist.

VII. Conclusion

Pursuant to applicable statutes and regulations, Requester expects a determination regarding expedited processing within ten calendar days. See 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(6)(E)(ii).

Please provide all records in electronic format. If this request is denied in whole or in part, Requester asks that ICE and DHS justify each withholding by reference to a specific FOIA exemption, release all reasonably segregable portions of otherwise exempt material, and provide an index of records withheld. Requester reserves the right to appeal any decision to withhold information or to deny a waiver or limitation of fees. See 6 C.F.R. § 5.9.

If you determine that another DHS component, office, or contractor maintains responsive records, please refer this request to that office and notify Requester of the referral rather than closing this request.

Thank you for your prompt attention to this matter. Please furnish the applicable records to:

Michael Wriston Project Salt Box projectsaltbox@pm.me

I affirm that the information provided in support of the request for expedited processing is true and correct to the best of my knowledge and belief. See 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(6)(E)(vi).

Sincerely,

Michael Wriston
Investigative Reporter
Project Salt Box